



Phosphophyllite

△ Piece of superb-coloured, facet-grade phosphophyllite rough

Phosphophyllite is a rare mineral and an even rarer gemstone, highly prized by museums and collectors. Crystals with a delicate bluish-green colour are the most sought after. Phosphophyllite is brittle and fragile, and can be faceted only with the greatest difficulty. It is rare as a gem partly because crystals that are large enough to cut are also too valuable to be broken. The finest crystals, and the ones that provided most of the existing faceted stones, came from the deposit at Potosí, Bolivia, which is now exhausted.

Specification

Chemical name	Hydrated zinc phosphate	Formula	$Zn_2(Fe^{2+}Mn^{3+})(PO_4)_2 \cdot 4H_2O$
Colours	Colourless to deep bluish-green	Structure	Monoclinic
Hardness	3–3.5	SG	3.08–3.10
RI	1.59–1.62	Lustre	Vitreous
Streak	White	Locations	USA, Australia, Germany, Bolivia



Crystals | Rough | This specimen features a cluster of light blue phosphophyllite crystals resting on a groundmass of pyrite. The gemmy crystals are of fine quality and would make good faceting material.

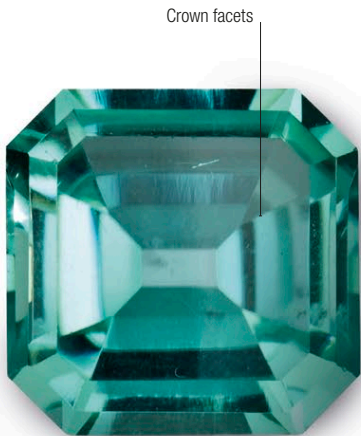
Gemmy crystals



High-quality phosphophyllite | Rough | Facet-grade phosphophyllite of this transparency and turquoise colour is rare, and will make a first-rate collector's gem.



Exceptional colour | Colour variety | These phosphophyllite crystals in parallel growth are a stunningly rare colour, and will be sought after by serious gem cutters.



Emerald cut | Cut | This light blue-green phosphophyllite gem faceted in an emerald cut has unusual clarity, adding to its value.



Emerald cut | Cut | An unusually transparent phosphophyllite is faceted here into an emerald step cut to emphasize its colour and high transparency.

Phosphophyllite is named after the Greek words for “phosphorus-bearing” and “cleavable”